

CSE0001 - DIGITAL LITERACY

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Introduction:

Digital literacy is an essential skill in today's technology-driven world. It involves the ability to use digital tools effectively, safely, and responsibly. It is an individual's ability to find, evaluate, and communicate information using digital devices or digital media platforms.

Digital literacy combines technical and cognitive abilities; it includes using technologies to create, evaluate, and share information, and critically examining their impacts

This project aims to develop an understanding of digital platforms, online safety, and professional communication skills through practical tasks.

In the scenario, I have been selected as a Student Digital Ambassador and assigned the responsibility of helping peers navigate the digital world effectively and responsibly. My first assignment is to build a Digital Literacy Portfolio, so the main objective of this project is to build a Digital Literacy Portfolio that demonstrates skills such as creating professional online profiles, communicating through formal emails, using digital tools, and understanding cyber safety.

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

In this task, I have created an infographic on digital literacy. The infographic covers key concepts such as the definition of digital literacy, essential digital tools, online safety practices, etiquette to be followed in digital professional communication and the importance of responsible digital behaviour.

For completing this task, I have used *Canva* and the design includes key elements of digital literacy such as essential digital tools, online safety, communication, and responsible use of technology and also how we can maintain a good digital portfolio. Each section is clearly separated with icons and headings, making the content easy to understand at a glance.

This task helped me understand how to present information clearly using digital tools. One thing that I found interesting is how there are tools which I can use to create content, represent information and perform wide range of creative tasks effectively. However, I found it slightly difficult to maintain the balance of text and visuals, as too much information could make the design cluttered.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

A professional digital presence is no longer optional — it is expected. In this task, I created and reviewed my profiles on platforms such as GitHub, LinkedIn and Stack Overflow to set up my portfolio across the key platforms that employers, internship coordinators, and the academic community check.

In this task, I learned the importance of maintaining a professional online presence. I updated my profiles with relevant information, added a profile description, and ensured that my digital identity reflects my academic and career interests.

GitHub is mainly used for storing and managing code, collaborating on projects, and showcasing programming work. LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where users can build their profiles, connect with industry professionals, and explore job or internship opportunities. Stack Overflow is a platform where developers ask and answer technical questions related to programming and software development.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use GitHub to upload my coding projects and showcase my programming skills. I will use LinkedIn to connect with professionals, apply for internships, and stay updated with industry trends. I will also use Stack Overflow to solve coding problems and contribute by answering questions as my knowledge grows.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms:

This task builds familiarity with two categories: coding practice platforms and cloud collaboration tools.

In this task, I explored HackerRank and solved a beginner-level problem to understand coding practices and the working of such platforms. I gained real time experience in writing and executing code in a structured environment. Additionally, I created a Google Form quiz with five questions related to digital literacy and linked it to a response sheet. This task helped me understand how programming platforms can be used to enhance my problem-solving skills, using digital tools for collaboration and data collection.

These tools will be highly useful for me academically. HackerRank will help me continuously improve my coding skills and prepare for technical assessments and placements. Google Forms will assist me in conducting surveys, gathering feedback, and organizing information for projects and presentations. Overall, this task helped me gain practical exposure to important digital tools that will support my learning throughout my academic journey.

Task 4: Email Etiquette:

This task tested whether I can apply email etiquette and whether I can communicate professionally online.

In this task, I drafted two professional emails—one requesting an assignment extension and another expressing interest in a summer internship. I learned the importance of proper email structure, tone, and clarity in professional communication how to use the essential components of email writing. I got to know the basic aspects of digital communication.

Also, I created a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist. It is a simple checklist with Do's and Don'ts for responsible social media use as a college student. While accomplishing this part of the task, I learned the important rules which I should keep in mind while using social media. And how my today's posts on social media can impact my future opportunities.

A situation where poor digital communication caused a problem- A student searching for internships, sent an email to internship coordinator at a company without proper etiquette. The student failed to explain his message clearly, missed the subject line, professional greeting in the email. The email was poorly structured and showed lack of communication etiquette. This formed a negative impact on the coordinator that the candidate is not suitable for the opportunity.

This issue could have been avoided by following basic email etiquette. The student should include a clear subject line, use a respectful greeting, and explain their intention properly in a structured manner. Proofreading the email before sending is also important to avoid errors. Proper communication ensures that the message is understood clearly and creates a positive impression. This highlights the importance of being careful and professional while communicating online.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide:

This task involves researching cybercrime and producing an awareness resource. The cybercrime which I chose is UPI/Online Payment Fraud, and my work includes and answers the most important questions about it, it acts as an awareness resource of such frauds and cyber threats. I myself had zero prior knowledge about this cyber fraud but now I am aware about it and know how to protect myself against it.

While conducting my research, I was surprised by the fact how real and authentic these fraudsters act and how vulnerable we are against these threats in today's world. I don't use UPI, but in the future when I will do so I will make sure that I don't believe any fraudster and allow any suspicious software on my device.

Learning Outcomes of the Project

Through this project, I developed:

- Understanding the concept of digital literacy
- Skills in creating presentations and online forms and learned how to use digital tools properly to represent information
- Awareness of online safety, professional and responsible behaviour
- Experience in coding and using collaboration tools
- Ability to communicate online in professional set up
- Knowledge of digital portfolio and how to build one
- Knowledge of appropriate usage social platforms and how to safeguard myself against cyber threats
- Awareness about how my online activities impact my future.

Conclusion

This project significantly enhanced my digital skills and deepened my understanding of the responsible and effective use of technology in everyday life. Through various tasks, I learned how to use digital tools for communication, collaboration, and problem-solving. It also helped me understand the importance of maintaining a professional online presence on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn. Additionally, I improved my ability to write structured and professional emails, which is an essential skill for academic and career growth. Overall, this project increased my awareness of digital safety, improved my confidence in using technology, and prepared me for future academic and professional challenges.

References:

- **Canva (digital tool used for infographic)**
- **HackerRank (coding platform)**
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Digital_literacy
- <https://razorpay.com/blog/upi-frauds-types-tactics/>
- <https://www.usnews.com/education/best-colleges/articles/social-media-dos-and-donts-for-college-students>

THANK YOU

